

Vivo V30 Pro

The Aura of Zeiss comes to Vivo V-series, but all isn't good

The Vivo V30 Pro, although a mid-range smartphone, is an expensive one at that. Starting at a price of Rs 41,999 and going all the way up to Rs 46,999 is touching the high-end category, so by default I wasn't able to test this smartphone as a mid-ranger. But even for a high-end smartphone, it holds up. Yes, there are many things that also don't add up, but Vivo's unwavering focus on bringing a flagship-level camera experience to the V-series has paid off.

DESIGN

Now design, like every year, is one of the best parts about the Vivo V30 Pro. The phone like its predecessors, comes with curved front and back panels. The smartphone is also super lightweight and handy. At just 7.5mm thickness and 188 grams of weight, the Vivo V30 Pro is also very slim and light, despite the big dimensions with the 6.78-inch display.

This time around, we are also getting an IP rating, the Vivo V30 Pro offers IP54 dust and splash resistance, which is fine but in a Rs 42,000 smartphone, there could have been a higher level of protection since IP54 I have also seen in sub-Rs 20,000 smartphones. We also get Schott Xensation scratch resistance on the display, so there is some level of protection in all aspects, if not the best or most justifiable.

Now, like I said, the Vivo V30 Pro looks very good. The smartphone has this nice texture on the back panel, which resembles waves in the ocean. Vivo has used what it calls "3D particle technology" to give this wave-like effect. Looks very good. We got the "Andaman Blue" colour for our review, which has this wave-like texture on the back panel, making it seem like the particles are inside the glass back panel. There is also the "Classic Black" colourway,

₹41,999



which comes with a rather simple matte finish frosted glass back.

So the design, like all Vivo V-series smartphones, remains nice and quirky. I like the Vivo V30 Pro's look and feel. It gives a very premium feel to the user and of course, for a roughly Rs 42,000 price

tag, it should feel premium. The only thing about the design is that there could have been a higher level of IP rating, since the brand is asking for a significant price.

DISPLAY

Coming to display, we get a nice 6.78-inch curved AMOLED display with an FHD+ (1260 x 2800) resolution and 120Hz refresh rate. The display is claimed to offer up to 2,800 nits of peak brightness, but that is subject to testing. Now, the 120Hz refresh rate obviously makes things super smooth and slick when scrolling through menus and apps. So while using the smartphone, the feeling is nothing short of being buttery smooth.

This display is also very vibrant and immersive. I used the Vivo V30 Pro for watching movies and TV shows for a bit and the experience was immersive. A bit of it was mired by the absence of stereo speakers since we all have the habit of just popping things open to watch without connecting any headphones.

While the display is vibrant, it is a bit too vibrant, meaning the colours are not accurate. We tested the colour accuracy using the Calman Colorchecker analysis and found that this display isn't the most colour accurate. While in general, the Vivo V30 Pro showcased good results with an average DeltaE of 2.8 (a DeltaE of 3.0 or below is considered good for smartphones), it is much behind its competitors.

In the grayscale test, however, the smartphone showcased good results. The Vivo V30 Pro tracked the Gamma value of 2.2 very accurately and showcased pretty decent RGB balance.

Now coming to the brightness, Vivo claimed a peak brightness of 2,800 nits, which is the brightest 1 percent of the whole display so you won't see the 2,800 nits at all times. We put this also to test using a Lux Meter and the Vivo V30 Pro showcased a very good luminance of 1542 nits under bright sunlight. The lowest we could get was 8, which means that this AMOLED display has a good range.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the Vivo V30 Pro comes with a MediaTek Dimensity 8200 SoC paired with up to 12GB of RAM. Now this is the same chip as the one we saw on the Vivo V30 Pro's predecessor, the Vivo V29 Pro and the synthetic benchmarks are also similar. In CPU benchmarks, there is practically no jump in performance and the numbers remain pretty much the same. What is more problematic, is that this was the case last year as well with the Vivo V29 series where we saw practically no jump in performance from the V27 Pro to the V29 Pro.

And while all the talk about the Vivo V-series users not looking at performance or it doesn't matter much since the smartphone's main focus is camera and experience and design is fair, it just doesn't